

Without using a third-party tool, how would you display your company's logo on the Windows XP logon and shutdown screens?

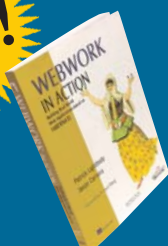
Write in with the subject 'Take a crack', and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com with your solution

Display a logo on the XP logon and shutdown screens



LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Win!



Take a Crack and win

Webwork In Action

by Patrick Lightbody
Jason Carreira

Published by **WILEY-INDIA**

LAST MONTH'S WINNER

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Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

How would you hide one or more drives of your computer from appearing in your Windows Explorer?

There are two ways to hide drive letters that appear in My Computer: via the Registry Editor and via the Group Policy Editor.

Method 1: Via The Registry Editor

Open the Registry Editor. Navigate to the string
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer

Create a new DWORD value and name it NoDrives. All drives will be visible as long as this value's data is set to 0. Set the value for NoDrives according to the following list: enter the decimal number corresponding to the drive(s) you want to hide as the NoDrives value data. When you right-click on NoDrives and choose Modify, make sure you select Decimal, not Hexadecimal.

Drive	Value
A:	1
B:	2
C:	4
D:	8
E:	16
...	...
Z:	33554432
All drives	67108863

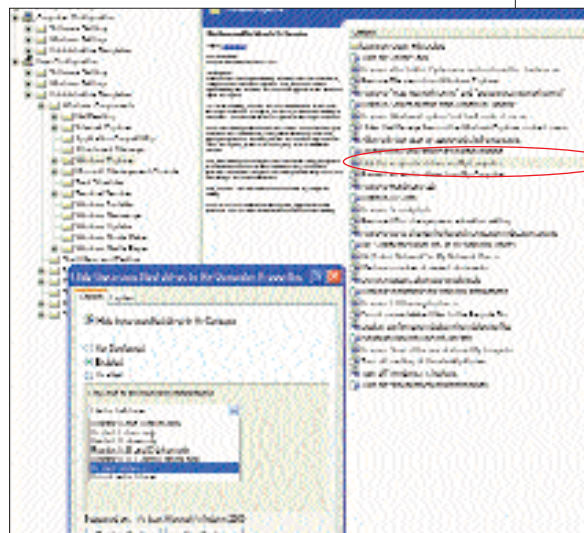
To hide multiple drives, just add the drives' values. For example, if you want to hide both drives A: and D:, the NoDrives value should be $1 + 8 = 9$.

Using the same decimal values, you

can arrange for a different behaviour that will leave a drive visible, while making it impossible for a user to view the contents of the drive. It will also prevent him from using the commands Run, Map Network Drive, or Dir to view the contents of folders on the drives. To do this, create a new DWORD value called NoViewOnDrive and use the same values as above.

Method 2: Using The Group Policy Editor

This method can be used only on Windows XP Professional Edition. Open the Group



Editing the appropriate Group Policy Editor settings

Policy Editor (Start > Run, type in "gpedit.msc" and press [Enter]). Go to User Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Explorer. Here, you'll find "Hide these specified drives in My Computer" and "Prevent access to drives from My Computer".

The difference between the two settings is that "Prevent access" will allow the user to see the drive icon, but will give an error message when he tries to access it. "Hide" will remove the icon so the user won't see it, but the drive can still be accessed by using Start > Run and keying in the drive letter.

Under this setting, after you click the radio button next to "Enable", you'll see several options. Choose the one you want to apply, for example, "Restrict A and B drives only". You'll notice that the options here are restricted; you cannot, for example, choose to restrict drives A, B and D. ■